Semicolons

In CoffeeScript there are no semicolons.[1] Although they're allowed, you never need them, and they shouldn't be used.

[1] Sure, ECMA-262 says that JavaScript parsers should do automatic semicolon insertion, but the potential for errors in JavaScript has resulted in frequent advice to always use them.

Return statements

The `return` keyword is absent from CoffeeScript. In CoffeeScript the last expression in the function is returned without any `return` statement. This is called an *implicit return*. Although required occasionally, explicit `return` statements are rarely used in CoffeeScript.

Curly braces

In CoffeeScript there are no curly braces used to mark out blocks of code. In order to remove the need for curly braces and other block-delimiting characters, newlines and the indentation level for each line of code are meaningful. This is referred to as *significant whitespace* or sometimes as the *offside rule*.[2] Indentation matters in CoffeeScript programs, so you must be careful to indent consistently. Always use either two, three, or four spaces in CoffeeScript. Two spaces is the most common. If you use mixed indentation (sometimes using two, sometimes using five, sometimes using four), then your CoffeeScript might still compile, but it will almost certainly not do what you want it to. Almost all CoffeeScript programs you'll find in the wild use spaces. Using tabs is not recommended.

[2] Significant indentation will already be familiar to Python and F# programmers and anybody who has used HAML or SASS.

As you now turn your attention to expressions and some basic language features of CoffeeScript, keep the rules about `var`, semicolons, `return` statements, and curly braces in the back of your mind until you encounter them again. Unfortunately, reading about basic language features is a little bit like reciting the alphabet or playing musical scales. On the upside, once you see these basic features, you're better prepared for the real fun stuff.